

US LinkedIn Pre-Job Posting Growth Playbook

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Objective:

Build a US-focused, relevant network of students, graduates, and early-career talent **before posting jobs**, using content engagement, meaningful connections, and algorithm training.

1 Target Universities – Mid & Lower Tier (US Focus)

Tier	University Name	Focus Area	Why Target	LinkedIn Search Tips
Mid	San Jose State University	CS / Engineering	High internship demand	Search: "San Jose State University Computer Science student"
Mid	University of Illinois Chicago	CS / IT	Urban student base, active job seekers	Filter by location: US, students, Open to Work
Mid	Florida International University	CS / Engineering	Large undergraduate population	Graduation year: 2024–2026
Mid	George Mason University	Engineering / IT	DC tech ecosystem	Keywords: CS, IT, Software
Mid	Arizona State University	CS / SWE	High LinkedIn engagement	Search groups: "ASU CS Students"
Mid	University of Houston	Engineering / Tech	Diverse student base	Students + "Open to Work"
Mid	New Jersey Institute of Technology	Engineering / CS	Strong technical focus	Include "Internship 2025"
Lower	California State University – East Bay	CS	High internship seekers	Location: Bay Area, US
Lower	University of North Texas	IT / CS	Growing tech graduates	Filter: undergraduates + Open to Work
Lower	CUNY City College	Engineering	NY-based job seekers	Graduation 2025
Lower	Pace University	CS / IT	NYC student network	Include "Seeking Internship"
Lower	Temple University	Engineering / Tech	High LinkedIn activity	Filter: Students & recent grads
Lower	University of Central Florida	CS	Large student base	Join university alumni groups

Tier	University Name	Focus Area	Why Target	LinkedIn Search Tips
Lower	University of Massachusetts Lowell	Engineering / CS	Technical focus	Use “Computer Science student USA”

Search Tip: Use LinkedIn filters — “Location: United States,” “Current student,” “Open to Work.”

2 Target Companies – Mid-Size & Startups (US)

Category: SaaS / Tech Startups (50–500 employees)

Company	Category	Why Follow / Engage
Slack	SaaS	Post intern hiring updates, comment on employee posts
Zapier	SaaS / Remote	Remote culture, repost announcements
Asana	SaaS	US engineering roles, engage with entry-level updates
Notion	SaaS	Early career hiring posts, comment on updates
Monday.com	SaaS	Software interns, entry-level developers

Category: FinTech / Payments

Company	Category	Why Follow / Engage
Brex	FinTech	Engaged student network, early hires
Chime	FinTech	Entry-level software & dev roles
Stripe	FinTech	High engagement posts, repost & comment
Plaid	FinTech	US intern-focused posts, software positions

Category: AI / ML Startups

Company	Category	Why Follow / Engage
OpenAI	AI / ML	Post/comment on research/tech updates
Hugging Face	AI / ML	Early career/remote roles for AI students
Runway	AI / ML	Entry-level roles, repost content
Anthropic	AI / ML	Students interested in AI research

Category: EdTech

Company	Category	Why Follow / Engage
Coursera	EdTech	Post student-friendly internship info
Udemy	EdTech	Comment on learning posts, engage students
Duolingo	EdTech	Entry-level & internship hiring posts
Khan Academy	EdTech	Comment on educational posts

Category: Remote-First / Fully Remote Companies

Company	Category	Why Follow / Engage
GitLab	Remote SaaS	Engage with remote developers, repost content
Automattic Remote		US remote dev hiring
Toptal	Remote	Entry-level opportunities and events
Buffer	Remote	Tech internships, repost updates

Search Tip: Use “Company size: 51–500” + “Location: United States” to find more mid-sized startups.

3 LinkedIn Groups to Join / Search

Group Keyword	Target Audience
US Software Engineering Internships	CS / SWE students
Entry Level Developers USA	Graduates seeking entry-level roles
Computer Science Students USA	Students & recent grads
Remote Tech Jobs United States	Remote job seekers
2025 CS Graduates USA	Graduating students
Junior Software Developers USA	Early-career developers
US Internship & Co-op Network	US interns
Women in Tech USA (Students)	Female tech students
Bootcamp Graduates USA	Coding bootcamp students
IT & CS Student Network USA	General tech students
US STEM Undergraduates	Undergrad talent
University Career Center Alumni Groups (US)	US university grads

Search Tip: Use LinkedIn’s group search bar with these keywords and filter for **active groups with +500 members**.

4 Search Keywords for US Connections

Category	Keywords / Phrases
Students	Computer Science Student United States
Students	Software Engineering Student USA
Students	Information Technology Student USA
Graduates	2025 Graduate Computer Science
Graduates	Entry Level Developer USA
Graduates	Actively Seeking Software Role USA
General	Open to Work United States
General	Seeking Internship 2025 USA
General	Remote Job Opportunities USA

Search Tip: Combine with filters like “Current Student,” “Graduation Year 2024–2026,” and location “United States.”

5 Daily & Weekly Safe Action Plan

Activity	Daily / Weekly Limit	Notes
Connection Requests	20–25/day	US students only; personalized template optional
Profile Visits	10–15/day	Only relevant profiles
Meaningful Comments	10–15/day	See comment strategy
DMs	2–3/day	Only warm leads after engagement
Posts	2 value posts/week	Week 1–2: Advice / Week 3–4: Soft recruitment tips
Warmup Period	14 days	Pre-job posting; feed training

6 Comment Strategy (Detailed)

Post Type	Example Comment / Approach
Student Project Post	“Great work! Are you exploring internship or full-time tech roles?”

Post Type	Example Comment / Approach
Open to Work Post	"Excited to see your journey! Which roles are you targeting?"
Graduation Announcement	"Congrats! Are you planning internships or full-time roles in tech?"
Tech Event / Hackathon	"Looks amazing! Which skills did you focus on during this event?"
Resume Advice Post	"Helpful tips! I'd also suggest [small actionable advice]."

Tip: Focus comments on **engagement & insight**, not job pitching. 10–15 comments/day is safe.

7 Pre-Job Posting Content Strategy

Week 1–2 – Engagement/Authority:

- Post 1: "US Students – Biggest challenges applying for entry-level tech roles?"
- Post 2: "Top 3 Resume Mistakes I See in Entry-Level Software Engineering Applications"
- Post 3: "How to Make Your LinkedIn Profile Attractive for US Internships"

Week 3–4 – Soft Recruitment Positioning:

- Post 4: "Tips for Preparing for Your First Technical Interview"
- Post 5: "5 Skills That Will Make You Stand Out for Remote US Jobs"

Note: Avoid posting direct job offers yet. Build trust & visibility first.

8 Advanced Algorithm Growth Strategy

1. **Profile Engagement Loop:** After connecting, visit, like, and comment on 1 post → LinkedIn pushes your profile to their network.
2. **Network Layering:** Connect in clusters: university → program → graduation year.
3. **Feed Training:** Only engage with US tech/student posts to train algorithm.
4. **Soft Authority Building:** Comment and repost career advice, not job ads.
5. **Content Positioning:** Resume tips, interview prep, US internship advice.

Goal: Build a feed and network of US students ready to engage with your posts once jobs are posted.

9 Safe LinkedIn Practices – Avoid Ban

- ≤50 connection requests/day
- No repeated copy-paste messages
- Don't spam posts across multiple groups simultaneously
- Limit mass DMs
- Only engage with relevant US students / companies

Result: Expect ~300–500 US student connections + relevant feed engagement in 30 days.